AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER



The Academy

Cybersecurity Learning Resources & Career Paths

24	6	100%
FREE TOOLS	FLAGSHIP PICKS	FREE / OPEN

2026 Edition — every link re-verified 2026-10-15.
License-aware curation: copyleft, freemium and free-tier entries are tagged inline.
Part of **Awesome Cyber Security Heaven** — 438 curated tools across 14 realms.

ABOUT THIS REALM

The Academy — Cybersecurity Learning Resources & Career Paths

Learn the craft — free academies, knowledge bases, walkthroughs and career roadmaps.

Structured learning: curricula, roadmaps and free course catalogs. We favor maintained, community-trusted material over link farms; archived classics stay listed when they remain the reference everyone cites.

- **Active in the last 30 days:** 4 of 10 tracked GitHub repos (40%)
- **Archived upstream (kept — still reference-quality):** [hacker-roadmap] (https://github.com/sundowndev/hacker-roadmap)
- **Quiet classics (no push in 2+ years, still the standard):** hacker-roadmap, SecuriBench Micro
- **Youngest entries:** Android Security Awesome (2014), Infosec Reference (2014), SecuriBench Micro (2014)

THE COLLECTION

All 24 tools — with live facts

Every entry below was checked against the GitHub API on 2026-10-15: star counts, project ages, last-push dates and licenses are re-snapshotted on every monthly verification pass. Flagship picks carry the **FLAGSHIP** badge — the tools this realm is built around. Everything is free, free-tier or open source: no paywalls, no SaaS wrappers.

PayloadsAllTheThings ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 81.8k · since 2016 · pushed 2026-08-27

the curated payload and methodology repo — copy, paste, understand, learn.

`github.com/swisskyrepo/PayloadsAllTheThings`

hacker-roadmap ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 15.7k | since 2018 | pushed 2023-10-16 ⏳

the illustrated cybersecurity study/career roadmap; the "where do I start?" answer.

`github.com/sundowndev/hacker-roadmap`

GTFOBins ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 13.7k | since 2018 | pushed 2026-05-27 | GPL-3.0

the living Linux binary-abuse matrix; the privilege-escalation bible.

`github.com/GTFOBins/GTFOBins.github.io`

OWASP MSTG ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 13.3k | since 2016 | pushed 2026-10-10

the Mobile Security Testing Guide: the canonical methodology for mobile app assessments. (CC-BY-SA-4.0)

`github.com/OWASP/owasp-mstg`

HackTricks ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 12.6k | since 2020 | pushed 2026-10-15 | free; custom content license

the pentester's playbook: technique-by-technique attack references from recon to post-exploitation.

`github.com/HackTricks-wiki/hacktricks`

Android Security Awesome ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 9.8k | since 2014 | pushed 2026-10-13 | Apache-2.0, curated list

curated Android security research: tools, papers and training.

`github.com/ashishb/android-security-awesome`

LOLBAS

★ 8.9k | since 2018 | pushed 2026-09-26 | GPL-3.0

the Windows counterpart to GTFOBins: living-off-the-land binaries and scripts.

`github.com/LOLBAS-Project/LOLBAS`

Infosec Reference

★ 6.0k | since 2014 | pushed 2025-10-20 | curated list

the giant information-security reference: tools, papers and guides in one place.

`github.com/rmusser01/Infosec_Reference`

Network Segmentation Cheat Sheet

★ 3.5k · since 2021 · pushed 2026-02-02 · Apache-2.0

practical segmentation architecture: VLANs, zones and rules that survive audits.

`github.com/sergiomarotco/Network-segmentation-cheat-`

SecuriBench Micro

★ 27 · since 2014 · pushed 2018-07-26 ⏳ · Apache-2.0

the Stanford benchmark suite for security-analysis tools.

`github.com/too4words/securibench-micro/`

PortSwigger Web Security Academy

free, best-in-class web-hacking labs from the Burp Suite team; the standard web-security curriculum.

`portswigger.net/web-security`

OWASP WSTG

the Web Security Testing Guide — the methodology standard for thorough assessments.

`owasp.org/www-project-web-security-testing-guide/`

OWASP Cheat Sheet Series

concise, developer-friendly defensive guidance per topic; the fix side of every finding.

`cheatsheetseries.owasp.org/`

Professor Messer

free complete video courses for Security+, Network+ and CySA+; the default free cert-prep resource.

`professormesser.com`

pwn.college

ASU's free hands-on curriculum from Linux basics to kernel exploitation, with dojo challenges.

`pwn.college`

IppSec

the legendary HTB walkthrough archive; watch a master work through every box, searchable by technique.

`ippsec.rocks`

LiveOverflow

deep-dive security videos that explain *why* things break — the channel every hacker watched.

`youtube.com/@LiveOverflow`

Hacker101

HackerOne's free web-security course: video lessons plus an always-on CTF for bug-bounty practice.

`hacker101.com/`

Hacksplaining

interactive security lessons for developers: exploit each vulnerability class, then patch it yourself.

`hacksplaining.com/`

Roppers Academy

free structured courses from computing fundamentals to security — the patient beginner's path.

`hoppersroppers.org/`

SEED Labs

the university-grade lab curriculum: hundreds of hands-on exercises for every security course topic.

`seedsecuritylabs.org/`

CTF Field Guide

Trail of Bits' field guide to capture-the-flag: from fundamentals to finals. (CC-BY-4.0)

`trailofbits.github.io/ctf/`

Bug Bounty Hunter

free service

free bug-bounty training platform: real methodology and lab targets.

bugbountyhunter.com/

Cyber Security Base

free course

free course series by Aalto University and F-Secure; from beginner to blue team.

cybersecuritybase.github.io/



Keep this realm alive

Awesome Cyber Security Heaven is a hand-curated, license-verified map of 438 free cybersecurity tools across 14 realms — maintained, re-verified and free forever (CC0). Star the repo, propose a tool, or explore the other 13 realms.

Featured: 2MNY Website Vulnerability Scanner

200 free, self-hosted protection modules — SQLi, XSS, SSRF, subdomain takeover, CMS and AI-stack checks with evidence-backed, CVSS-scored reports. One Docker command, zero API keys.

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven
2mny.com

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